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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021

\$2.50
Inc GST

No. 248

THURSDAY, September 3, 2026 ISSN 2653-2026



WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

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**Get ready
for Fong
Lees Lane
Festival - P3**



**Legacy
Week,
Dig deep -
P5**



**Wellington's
Apothecary
- P 9**

Johnstons rewarded for 50 years service

Local voulnunteers

John and Gaius Johnston

have given a combined

100 years of service to

the Wuuluman Rural

Fire Brigade.

THINGS LIKE this are probably lost on most city folk.

But in rural areas, joining your local district bush-fire brigade is a natural – you volunteer to protect your property as well as that owned by others.

It's additional moral insurance.

Tuesday last week was a very important day for Wuuluman locals John and Gaius Johnston, who were both recognised for servicing as volunteers 50 years in the Wuuluman Rural Fire Service.

The medal presentation ceremony was conducted by Orana RFS Command Manager, Dave Millstead at Maranatha House in Wellington as both John and Gaius now reside there due to ill health.

Formerly Bush Fire Brigades, which they would have joined in 1976, the service has expanded to the now named Rural Fire Service, but just about every district in the state has or had a volunteer brigade.

Accompanying his parents was also Luke Johnston, currently the brigade's deputy captain, who was also presented a 20-year service medal.





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Bush Summit wrap up

THE Bush Summit last week was a ‘who’s who’ of politicians and industry leaders, and it was an opportunity that I took full advantage of to get in the ear and lobby for funding for our region.

The Prime Minister met for 35 minutes with Councillors, the General Manager and ‘Riverbank’ Frank Doolan on the Thursday morning.

It was quite a coup to secure this meeting and the PM was very generous with his time.

As a Council, it’s 100 per cent necessary to speak to all politicians and parties in government.

The PM was a really engaging character and listened attentively to all the points we raised of what is needed to make our region better.

Obviously, we aren’t going to agree on everything but it was good to hear the PM recount back all the main points of our conversation shortly after when he was on-stage at the Summit.

The PM must have a great memory, (or our points made an impression on him??) as he then landed all our main points again on the Thursday night at a Country Mayors Associ-

ation dinner in Sydney where he was the guest speaker.

I’ll now follow-up the PM and relevant Ministers as we try to get funding for these particular projects.

Scabbing Flat Bridge & Saxa Road – latest info

Last week when Jenny Aitchison, Minister for Roads and Regional Transport, was announcing planning for more overtaking lanes on the Mitchell Highway near Geurie, I had the opportunity to show the Minister the Scabbing Flat Bridge.

It was a very good opportunity to explain to the Minister exactly why a new dual-lane, concrete bridge is required, and there’s just never quite like seeing something with your own eyes rather than being told about it via a Zoom meeting.

Transport for NSW have been conducting a review into The Timber Truss Bridge Conservation Strategy, and I’m reliably informed that public consultation will be opened near the end of September.

The Strategy is a comprehensive approach

to preserving the historical and architectural integrity of the timber truss road bridges in NSW.

The review will give the community an opportunity to have a say on why the Scabbing Flat Bridge needs to be retained or replaced.

As is well known, the many in the local Geurie/Scabbing Flat areas, and further afield, are keen to see the Section 170 heritage status removed from the bridge which will allow funding to be pursued for a replacement.

Visit from the Australian Energy Infrastructure Commissioner

Tony Mahar, the Australian Energy Infrastructure Commissioner (AEIC) dropped into Council this week on his way to Dunedoo to meet with locals impacted by the renewable energy transition.

The AEIC is an independent role appointed by the Federal Government, reporting to the Minister for Climate Change and Energy.

The Commissioner covers all of Australia listening to concerns raised by community members, and then makes recommendations

back to government on what policy should be implemented to get much better outcomes. It’s a real shame that more of the Commissioner’s recommendations aren’t adopted by the government!!

Other areas that the AEIC deals with include:

- * Help with complaints and enquiries from people about new or existing wind farms, large solar farms (5 MW or more), energy storage sites like pumped hydro or large batteries (1 MW or more), and major powerline projects. You can make a complaint or enquiry at the website.

- * Conduct engagement and then share insights and advice into best practice approaches. For example - complaints handling, working with communities, and emerging issues.

- * Make information about energy transition and specific projects easier to find and understand. And,

- * Work across government and with other stakeholders on implementing the recommendations of the AEIC Community Engagement Review 2023.

Josh Black

State of the industry report gives Aus Grain a tick of approval, but risks remain

THE AUSTRALIAN grain industry has posted another successful five years on the back of grower ingenuity, innovation and resilience, according to GrainGrowers’ 2026 State of the Australian Grain Industry Report.

Released every five years and the only one of its kind produced for the Australian grain industry, the report analyses data from a range of sources and identifies trends, risks and opportunities for the sector. GrainGrowers Chair Rhys Turton said despite an everchanging growing and operating environment, the report showed continued productivity growth across the industry with Australia’s five largest grain production seasons on record occurring in the past six years.

“These long-term productivity gains are underpinned by growers’ ability to adopt new technologies, maintain sustainable farming practises and expertly manage climate volatility,” Mr Turton said. “Importantly, the volume of grain grown has increased significantly while the area planted has only increased modestly, which shows growers are making the most of every hectare.”

But the past five years have not been without their challenges as new trends emerged which were far less pronounced five years ago.

“The risks posed by global volatility have heightened in recent years, driven by geopolitical tensions, ongoing supply chain disruptions and a renewed rise in protectionist and interventionist trade policies in

key markets,” Mr Turton said.

“It has never been more important for the industry to work with government to address the challenges and support growers in realising the opportunities before them.”

Key Facts

- * The five-year production average has increased from 44m tonnes in 2020-21 to 64m tonnes in 2025-26 – an increase of 45 per cent.

- * The sector’s average economic contribution over the last five years has been \$27 billion per annum.

- * There are 37,000 grain farmers across Australia on 18,000 farms – 69pc of farms employ workers on farm.

- * Five of the last 6 years have been the biggest production years on record.

- * The sector has continued to increase the volume of grain produced at a faster rate than the area of land farmed.

- * Australia is a major producer and exporter in the global grain sector, exporting 39.6 million tonnes in 2024-25.

- * Australia’s five biggest export markets on a volume basis include China, Indonesia, Japan, Philippines and Vietnam.

- * Australia is responsible for:
10pc of global wheat exports
20pc of global canola and barley exports
40pc of global chickpea exports

Community groups can share \$500,000 to help deliver road safety initiatives

COMMUNITY GROUPS are invited to apply for a share of \$500,000 in funding to deliver local road safety initiatives, with the latest round of the NSW Government’s Community Road Safety Grants program now open.

Eligible not-for-profit and charity organisations have the opportunity to apply for grants of up to \$5000, or up to \$30,000 to fund local road safety initiatives.

Since its inception in 2015, the Community Road Safety Grants program has distributed more than \$4.1 million to not-for-profit and

charity organisations across NSW.

These grants allow local groups to deliver small, community-based projects that enhance the important message of road safety where it matters most.

Twenty projects were selected to be funded last year.

They targeted specific road user groups, including Aboriginal communities, people from culturally and linguistically diverse

backgrounds, young people, and vulnerable road users, like pedestrians and cyclists.

Last year’s funded projects spanned across multiple NSW electorates and Local Government Areas, with 13 projects in metropolitan NSW and seven in regional NSW.

The 2026 Community Road Safety Grants are now open for applications and will close at 4pm on Monday 28 September 2026.

Letter to Editor

Looking for relatives of jockey Alan Warne

Editor

I am writing on behalf of a friend who I am assisting in trying to find a family or family members of a jockey named Alan Warne.

My friend has recently inherited a box of photos from a deceased relative which includes a large photo of Warne riding the winner of a race at Dubbo in 1950. (trainer J Weldon).

My friend has no interest in retaining this large photo and would like it to be offered to a family member of the jockey.

As there is a Warne Street in Wellington, I presume at some stage a family of that name has had some relationship with the town, and there could be descendants still there, possibly not with that surname though.

I have checked an old phone book which includes only one Warne, living in Bourke in 2010.

If your readers have any information about the Warnes, would you please let me know.

(Mrs) Pip Brown

Name and address supplied

But enquire through the editor – Mark Griggs

\$100 rego discount for more than 4.4 million NSW vehicles

DRIVERS ACROSS New South Wales renewing their vehicle registration due from September 1 will pay \$100 less to register their privately owned vehicle, while motorcyclists will pay \$80 less for their rego.

The \$100 registration discount will benefit the owners of more than 4.4 million vehicles across the state, putting money back into the pockets of families facing ongoing cost-of-living pressures.

Around 360,000 privately owned light vehicles are due for registration renewal in September alone.

For drivers whose rego was due in July or August, the \$100 discount will be applied when their registration is renewed in 2027.

Eligible motorists do not need to do anything to receive the discount. It will automatically apply when an owner receives notification that their eligible vehicle is:

- * due for registration
- * when a new vehicle is registered in NSW; and
- * is re-registered in NSW after previously being unregistered.

Drivers can view their registration details and switch to digital registration reminders in their MyServiceNSW account and in the Service NSW app.

This is the easiest way to manage vehicle registration and stay up to date.

On top of rego relief, the Government is also helping families with the cost of transport to help ease the pressure on household budgets including:

- * lowering the weekly toll cap to \$50 for 12 months as well as removing toll administration fees which cost motorists \$60 million last year; and
- * freezing Opal fares at 2025 prices for the next 12 months.

Wellington & District
LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O’Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

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Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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Fong Lees Lane Festival returns - a month earlier

WELLINGTON'S SIGNATURE celebration of food, culture and community, Fong Lees Lane Festival, transforming a hidden laneway into a vibrant gathering place filled with global flavours, live entertainment and old-world charm returns on Friday evening, September 11 from 4 to late. Now a much-loved event, the festival showcases a diverse range of local food vendors, giving visitors the opportunity to experience authentic cuisines from around the world and within our community while supporting local businesses and community groups.

This year's festival will feature the award-winning and delightfully quirky three-piece band The Hillbilly Goats, whose high-energy blend of folk, bluegrass and bush music promises to keep the laneway buzzing throughout the evening. Visitors will also enjoy the spectacle of the traditional Chinese lucky Dragon weaving its way through the crowd, adding colour, excitement and cultural flair. More than just a food festival, Fong Lees Lane is about bringing people together. Families, friends and visitors of all ages

are invited to soak up the warm, welcoming atmosphere that has become the festival's trademark. Presented by Wellington Arts, the event celebrates the rich cultural diversity of our region while creating opportunities for local businesses, volunteers and community organisations to connect with thousands of visitors. Fong Lees Lane has become one of Wellington's most anticipated community events, offering an unforgettable evening of outstanding food, entertainment and community spirit. This year we have 19 food vendors: Mexican, Turkish, German, Dutch, Chinese, American, Thai, Japanese, Italian Filipino offering Saltbush lamb, gourmet pies, woodfired pizzas, bratwurst, gozleme, loaded spuds, Philly Cheese steaks, arancini, hot dogs, pad Thai, popcorn, and of course for the sweet tooth; ice cream, souffle pancakes, gluten free donuts, Dutch Oliebollen and the Lolly Lady. FONG LEES LANE – Friday, September 11 from 4pm.

A new look for WATS Place

Come and see the transformation
The newly refurbished WATS Place will be open for the community to explore as part of Fong Lee's Lane Festival. WHILE REHEARSALS have been in full swing, WATS has also been busy behind the scenes with a major refurbishment of its long-standing premises at 31 Warne Street. Thanks to a generous grant from Energy Co, WATS Place has undergone a remarkable transformation, including a new roof,

new flooring, fresh paint and an updated kitchen. The refurbished venue will provide WATS with an improved and more welcoming space for its members, performers and the wider community for years to come. Everyone is invited to come along at 5.30pm on Friday 11 September to see the transformation for themselves and celebrate the next chapter for this much-loved local theatre organisation.

Local Land Services



Mixed Farming Forum

Bringing together leading researchers, consultants and local producers to share practical insights tailored to mixed farming businesses in the Central West.

Whether you're looking to improve livestock performance, explore alternative crop options, manage feed shortages, or better understand the economics of your operation, this forum will provide information you can take straight back to the farm.

When: 16 Sept 2026 | 9 am -3 pm
Where: Wellington Soldiers Memorial Hall,
75 Arthur St, NSW
Cost: \$30 (includes catered lunch)



Wellington Arts
presents

Fong Lees Lane Festival

Friday Sept 11th 4-9pm

Family friendly - Everyone's welcome!

wellingtonarts.org.au

Multicultural Foods
Street Dining
Lucky Dancing Dragon

Live Music from the
Hillbilly Goats

NSW marks Foster Care Week with landmark reform

A NEWstrategy which will provide more practical support for foster carers, has been unveiled during Foster and Kinship Care Week.

The new ‘Out-of-Home Care Carer Strategy’ is the State’s first dedicated strategy and has been developed in consultation with more than 1000 carers over the past two years.

There are over 15,000 foster carers in NSW who open their hearts and homes to vulnerable children. This week recognises their extraordinary contribution and invites more people to consider providing a safe and loving foster home.

The Strategy will not only provide more practical support for carers but seeks to empower them as they support the children

and young people in their care.

This Strategy is the only one of its kind in Australia and marks the State Government’s next steps to reform the NSW out-of-home care system.

Recent reforms supporting foster carers include:

- * a 20 per cent increase to the Care Allowance – the largest increase in the payment’s history
- * enhanced independent information and advice delivered by Carers for Kids
- * more than doubling the immediate emergency crisis payment to \$200 per child

As part of the Strategy, every out-of-home care provider will develop and publish a specific Carer Support Action Plan.

The Department of Communities and

Justice (DCJ) has published its plan for the next two years, with 45 detailed actions including a boost to carer training and choice.

Minister for Families and Communities Kate Washington said every foster carer who opens their heart and home to a vulnerable child deserves to be celebrated and supported.

“Our nation-leading carer strategy recognises foster carers as critical partners and commits to giving them more respect and support.

“This is the logical next step in our child protection reforms, after delivering the State’s biggest increase to the Foster Care Allowance, boosting emergency carer payments and strengthening practical

supports for carers.”

CEO of Carers for Kids NSW Renée Leigh said carers have told us clearly what they need to continue providing safe, stable and nurturing homes for children and young people, so it is vital to see their voices and importance reflected in this Strategy.

“A statewide approach creates an important opportunity for greater consistency in how carers are empowered and included in decisions that affect them and the children and young people in their care.

“Carers for Kids NSW will continue listening to and supporting carers across NSW, while working closely with government and the sector to help ensure these commitments translate into meaningful change in carers’ day-to-day experiences.”

Think before you click: stay safe online this Scam Awareness Week

LAST WEEK was Scam Awareness Week and residents were being urged to think twice before they click links that may appear genuine, with scammers increasingly using fake websites, fake social media posts and impersonation scams to steal money and personal information.

The theme this year was “no one’s just a number” – recognising that behind every scam statistic is a real person, family, business or community impacted by financial loss, identity theft or emotional distress.

NSW consumers are increasingly being targeted through digital channels, with scammers impersonating trusted brands, government agencies and businesses to create convincing fake communications designed to trick people into handing over money or personal information.

NSW residents reported almost 28,000 scams and \$56.7 million in losses to ScamWatch during the first half of 2026, highlighting the persistent threat posed by increas-

ingly sophisticated scam activity.

NSW makes up around one third of all reports and losses nationwide.

Last year, ID Support NSW provided advice and guidance to more than 75,000 customers whose personal information or identity documents had been compromised or misused.

NSW Fair Trading is also working with consumers and industry to examine scams in the property sector, including when criminals impersonate a solicitor, conveyancer or real estate agent and scam a person into transferring their money into a fraudulent account.

People are reminded to:

- * Stop before sharing money or personal information;
- * Check who they are really dealing with using independently sourced contact details; and
- * Protect themselves and others by reporting scams and

seeking support if they believe their identity or personal information has been compromised.

To help people stay vigilant against the threat of scams, ID Support NSW provides ongoing education through a range of online and in-person events.

Over the past year, ID Support NSW hosted and supported 220 identity protection presentations, community stalls and outreach events, reaching almost 116,000 people.

Consumers can access free practical advice, learning resources and support through ID Support NSW at www.nsw.gov.au/id-support-nsw.

People can also report scams to ACCC’s Scamwatch at <http://www.scamwatch.gov.au/report-a-scam>.

Consumers who experience problems with a business operating in NSW can lodge a complaint with NSW Fair Trading online at www.fairtrading.nsw.gov.au/help-centre/online-tools/make-a-complaint or by calling 13 32 20.

More Eisteddfod photos



Launch of Legacy Week



Wellington Legacy president Terry Melhuish and secretary Brett Tolhurst.

LEGACY WEEK began on Monday and runs through to this coming Sunday.

It's the time for all Australians to show their support for the widows and children whose loved ones have served our country.

During Legacy Week, thousands of volunteers across Australia will be in the community selling Legacy badges, bears and other merchandise to raise vital funds for veteran families.

Local Legacy members will be out and about Wellington during this

week selling merchandise or seeking donations.

They will be at the Coles complex Thursday and Friday and around the Hotels on Friday night.

Donations can also be given to the Wellington President Terry Melhuish.

Since 1923, Legacy has supported the families of veterans who have died or been seriously injured through military service, providing financial assistance, wellbeing programs, social connection opportunities and educational support.

The Legacy badge is a symbol of

support for veterans' families and the Australian values of mateship, compassion and fairness.

In New South Wales, Legacy supports some 10,000 partners and children of veterans who have given their lives or health in service to the nation.

Every Legacy badge purchased and every donation made helps provide life-changing support to veterans' families, ensuring they

receive the care, assistance and opportunities they need today and into the future.

NSW Minister for Veterans David Harris said Legacy Week was a time for all of us to pause and reflect on the extraordinary sacrifices made by Australia's veterans and their families.

"While we honour the service of those who have worn our nation's uniform, we also

recognise the families who have stood beside them through times of challenge, uncertainty and loss," Mr Harris said.

"I encourage everyone to show their support this week by making a small donation and purchasing a Legacy badge to help make a meaningful difference in the lives of veteran families and help Legacy continue its invaluable work."

Check out our website

Wellington & District
LEADER





Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House



✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School

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Government makes motor neurone disease notifiable

Government “Fire Sale” of historic Bathurst Barracks opposed

NSW WILL become the first jurisdiction in Australia to report cases of people living with motor neurone disease, with the State Government making it a notifiable condition from September 1.

Medical practitioners will be required to notify NSW Health of motor neurone disease cases, following the publication of the Public Health Amendment (Motor Neurone Disease) Order 2026.

This Australian-first initiative will provide NSW Health with a stronger evidence base to better understand motor neurone disease, and may assist with the future planning of healthcare services and funding for research into its potential causes, and possible future treatment options.

Motor neurone disease affects approximately eight in every 100,000 Australians, and 90 per cent of cases occur sporadically, without any apparent reason or family link.

It is a rare, progressive neurological disorder that causes rapid degeneration of muscle activity and can impair walking, talking, breathing and general functioning.

There is no cure for the disease.

A notifiable disease is a medical condition that by law must be reported to NSW Health by medical practitioners, hospitals, laboratories, and schools or childcare facilities, to help prevent and control the spread of certain diseases.

Data collected will include the case’s full name, address, date of birth, age, gender, Aboriginality, language spoken at home, country of birth, occupation/school, date of onset, date of notification, and date of death if applicable.

It will also include details about the referring doctor. The data collected will be kept confidential.

The State Government committed \$2 million funding for motor neurone disease research as part of the 2023-24 NSW Budget.

This included awarding three research grants to help improve the wellbeing and health outcomes for people living with the disease, and drive advancements in diagnostic tools to improve rates of early detection and referral.

These research projects are funded until late 2027, with progress reports due later this year.

I AM totally opposed to the fire sale of Racecourse Barracks, Bathurst.

Our veterans don’t support it, our Australian Defence Force personnel don’t support it, and I don’t support it either.

It’s a very shortsighted move that must be reversed.

Racecourse Barracks in Bathurst is home to our local Army Reserve unit, the 1/19th, also known as the ‘Bushmen’s Rifles’. It’s got a very long and proud history.



While the Bushmen’s Rifles is drawn from across Western New South Wales, selling off our Bathurst barracks will effectively lock out local residents from serving.

At a time when our Army Reserve is crying out for recruits, the government’s actually making it harder for members of the Bushmen’s Rifles to attend training.

We should be building our reserve forces up, not knocking them down and selling off the essential local infrastructure they rely on.

You cannot expect to grow our regional defence forces while stripping away the very infrastructure that makes serving possible.

This decision is also fundamentally wrong-headed from a practical perspective.

During World War II, Racecourse Barracks served as an armoured vehicle repair depot.

Local veterans have informed me that there’s all sorts of contaminated material buried on that site, so the government isn’t going to be making a big return on it anyway.

It’s baffling that we would decimate our local reserve units just to save on some lawnmowing

fees.

On paper, the Canberra bean counters may see 23 hectares of housing sites, but the contamination means there’s no motser to be made here.

And if they had just consulted with our local veterans, they would have known that.

If a conflict ever breaks out in the future, we’re going to need this site.

The facility already boasts first-rate accommodation for about 80 people, lecture rooms, and a first-class, modern armoury.

On a broader scale, our veterans are furious that the government is also selling Victoria Barracks in Sydney, trading away our military history and infrastructure for a relatively small return.

If we want units like the Bushmen’s Rifles to stay strong, you have to invest in our bases and make it easy for people to train together.

My message to the federal government and the Defence bean counters is crystal clear: this is a very poor decision, and the government needs to change course on this immediately.

They’re going to be hearing a lot more from me until they do.



tech talk

with Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

I OBTAINED my driver’s licence in the eighties. Spoiler alert: I’m getting old.

The main vehicle available for me to borrow was my brother’s 1967 Chrysler VC Valiant. Three-speed manual on the column, drum brakes and definitely none of the safety and convenience features we now all take for granted. I also raced dirt bikes from a very young age.

Those two facts are important to how I learned to brake.

On a dirt bike, or in a 1967 Valiant, applying the brakes heavily while turning was potentially a life-threatening sin. Always brake in a straight line then release the brakes to turn.

It became instinct. Then along came anti-lock braking systems. Mercedes-Benz introduced the first modern ABS on a production vehicle in 1978 and, by 2011, ABS was mandatory on all new passenger vehicles sold in Australia.

But nobody sent my brain the software update. In 2014, my eldest daughter was about to receive her provisional driver

6 THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,

licence. I decided advanced driver training would give her the best possible chance of surviving our roads.

During the lunch break, the instructor asked if I wanted to have a play on the skid pan. Absolutely!

My instructions were simple. Approach a rubber cone at 50km/h and, when told, perform an emergency stop while navigating around the cone.

I did exactly that.

Apparently, I was terrible.

No male enjoys being told he isn’t an expert driver. The course was for my daughter, but the instructor immediately diagnosed my problem.

He said it was obvious I had learned to drive in a non-ABS car. I was braking, releasing the brakes to steer, then braking again. After a few attempts I learned something remarkable. I could slam the brake pedal as hard as possible and, while ABS did its thing, steer around the cone.

Wow. The technology had changed, but my driving hadn’t.

WELLINGTON & DISTRICT LEADER

Which brings us to today’s cars.

Modern vehicles are increasingly loaded with Advanced Driver Assistance Systems, or ADAS.

They can automatically brake when a collision is imminent, warn us when we drift from our lane, help keep us within lane markings and detect vulnerable road users.

Yet there is a curious problem.

Many drivers find these systems annoying and switch them off.

An Australian study examined almost 100,000 collisions, conducted on-road testing with 50 drivers and surveyed more than 2000 motorists driving ADAS-equipped vehicles. The results suggest these systems could prevent more than 7000 road casualties each year if fully embraced, yet 60 per cent of drivers surveyed admitted switching off at least some of the technology.

Perhaps the problem isn’t the technology. Perhaps it’s us.

The research found that just one instructor-guided drive using the systems significantly increased drivers’ trust, confidence and

intention to use them.

That sounds suspiciously like my day on the skid pan. We spend enormous effort teaching young people how to drive, but comparatively little teaching experienced drivers how to drive a modern car.

Only 19pc of motorists who had recently completed driving lessons or licence testing reported receiving education about driver-assistance technology.

Meanwhile, the technology keeps advancing. Since August 1 this year, all new passenger vehicles sold in Australia have been required to have autonomous emergency braking capable of detecting pedestrians.

Lane Keep Assist is set to become compulsory in new passenger vehicles from March 2029.

Maybe the future of road safety doesn’t just require smarter cars. It requires smarter training. After decades behind the wheel, being told you need another driving lesson might bruise the ego.

Then again, a badly bruised ego still heals much faster than a few broken bones.

Who’s for cricket?

SUMMER SPORTS season is just around the corner with Australia’s number one sport “CRICKET” about to commence.

Wellington District Cricket Association with Cricket NSW Regional Officials are holding a “Come Try Cricket” session for all Juniors on Monday, September 7 at Rygate Park from 3.30pm.

Just need yourself, friends, sports clothing, hat, sunscreen and drink bottle. All ages and abilities welcome.

From this afternoon, parents and youngsters can then see if they would like to participate in one of the teams for Saturday morning

Competition Cricket or the Woolworths Masters Blasters Sessions on training afternoons - further information will be available from members of the Committee present.

In the meantime, Senior Cricket is calling for Expressions of Interest for a “seven-aside” Friday Twilight Competition commencing from 5pm for six weeks prior to Christmas.

All enquiries and expressions of interest can be made to members of the Committee through the Association’s facebook site.

This is one way the Association is trying to get Senior Cricket recommencing in Wellington.

BBQ’s get second life at the Men’s Shed

OLD barbecues discarded because they are rusted or neglected are getting a new life st the Men’s Shed.

Interestingly, shed member Ross doesn’t see them as landfill either. Instead, he rescues them.\

The hot plate and the grill are given a thorough clean (grease and rust).

Ross then weld’s them into a new

steel frame, attaches new leg’s and handles and even a warming tray to keep the billy hot.

No two barbecues Ross makes are the same.

They are just the thing for that Sunday BBQ or the upcoming camping trip now the weather is getting warmer.



Wellington Canoe & Kayak Club has formerly closed, but its spirit lives on as surplus funds were donated to Wellington Lions.

Pictured are Peter Sheridan and daughter Katrina passing on a cheque to the secretary and other members of Lions Club at the premises of Lions Preloved Books last week.

Lions secretary Chris Hardy said the money would come in very handy as the Lions had started giving away a sausage sanga and hot soup/drink every Wednesday evening to people who need a hot meal.

The members have also decided to open the preloved books premises every day during the school holidays as they are still giving away free books to children.

They thank everyone who has donated them and the many jigsaws/games/dvds and cds that have also been donated.

*Share your copy of this paper,
let everyone have a good read*



Ram Sale 2026

- Friday, 18th September
- 100 Rams on Offer
- Inspection: 10:00am
- Sale Commences: 1:00pm
- "Birrell Vale", 302 Burrel Creek Road, Dripstone

Scott Brien: 0409 467 477

Brad Wilson: 0417 467 911

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Water Delivery

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Servicing Wellington Region

Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

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in the “Sport” section.

Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
9am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month.
9am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month.
9am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington.

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Electrician reveals what you should never do during a power outage

Chris Madikian of Level 2 Electrician Sydney, has provided helpful advice on what to do and not to do during a blackout.

Avoid using candles; use a battery lantern instead

The first thing people normally do when the power goes out in the evening is light candles.

Candles are a risky option for lighting during a blackout. They do not provide as much light as a battery lantern or torch, and they carry a great risk of being knocked over.

They are especially risky in homes with pets or young children as a knocked-over candle can quickly lead to a house fire.

Make sure you are using a torch that is separate from the one on your phone.

You should conserve your phone’s battery in case of an emergency.

A battery-operated camping-style lantern provides plenty of light, is a safe option, and will last for years.

patios either.

Ventilation, such as opening a door or window, will not stop carbon monoxide from building up.

Leaving these outside, even in bad weather, will always be safer than running them indoors.

Avoid opening the refrigerator and freezer during the blackout

These appliances are designed to keep the cold air in.

Although it can be tempting to check on the food during a power outage, leave it be. A refrigerator will keep food cool for four hours, and a freezer will keep the food cold for up to 48 hours if they remain unopened.

One helpful hack is to always have a frozen water bottle in your freezer.

That way, you will know if the temperature has dropped significantly.

Do not attempt electrical work yourself

When the power first goes out, you might be wondering if it is just your house or the entire street.

It is safe to check if a safety switch was tripped, but other than that, you should not touch anything.

If you notice that your house is the only one without power, call your distributor.

If the entire street is affected, it is best to stay inside and never go near a fallen power line.

Even if the fallen power line is on your

property, the line could still be live and dangerous.

Do not attempt to move anything off the line, like outdoor furniture or children’s toys.

Once the power is restored, do not turn everything on at once

When you first notice the power has gone out, you should manually switch off any electronics that contain a circuit board.

This would include televisions, computers, and gaming consoles.

When the power comes back on, gradually switch these back on. This will help your own home and the neighbourhood, as every single electronic device will be starting up at the same moment, which could overwhelm your own switchboard and affect the network as a whole.

Turn on the essentials first, like heating or cooling, and then the non-essentials in a gradual manner.

Preparation and planning are key

Blackouts are often unexpected, so it is easier to plan ahead than to panic during one.

Keep lanterns, torches, non-perishable ready-to-eat foods, a power bank to charge your phone, a first aid kit, blankets, and water in an easily accessible place.

Spending a short time shopping and setting aside an accessible area in your home will make dealing with a blackout easier.

Tell our advertisers you saw it in the ‘Leader’

Around the electorate

with our State Member Dugald Saunders



Minister misses the mark on Mitchell Highway
LAST WEEK, Minister for Roads and Regional Transport, the Hon Jenny Aitchison MP, was in Dubbo to announce that the Minns Labor Government is planning a much-needed new overtaking lane on the Mitchell Highway, west of Geurie.
While this seems great, there’s some truths behind this announcement that have been overlooked.
What the Minister has announced is simply a commitment to planning an overtaking lane. No money has been allocated to the project and there is no guarantee it will even receive the green light to go ahead.
It’s also important to point out this announcement is only for one overtaking lane, despite our community calling for three to four more overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo for years.
The Nationals and Liberals Coalition understands what the community wants, which is why we did the work and committed \$32 million to build those overtaking lanes in March 2023.
Instead of pursuing this project to improve safety on the Mitchell Highway after they

were elected, the condition of the road has been left to deteriorate and the speed limit between Wellington and Dubbo has been reduced on this Labor Government’s watch.
A new overtaking lane seems to be their shortsighted solution now the pressure is on from public backlash.
Road users deserve solutions that address the root causes of risk on our roads, and that includes proper investment in road infrastructure.
One additional overtaking lane is simply not enough to improve this stretch of the Mitchell Highway, and the Minister knows that. Minister Aitchison had the chance to show she’s listening to what our community wants, but this announcement has missed the mark big time.
Hopefully the last influx of signatures on the petition calling for more overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo will inspire the Minister to change the scope of this project before it’s too late.

Bush Summit
It was a massive two days for our region with the return of the National Bush Summit to Dubbo last week.
The Prime Minister, Premiers, Ministers

and other politicians from around the country descended on the Dubbo Civic Centre to join industry leaders and community advocates in conversations about what’s really happening in the regions.
It was a great opportunity to put our region back in the national spotlight and it was also fantastic to see so many locals have their say.
A massive congratulations goes out to Dubbo’s Molly Croft, who was a joint-winner of the Youth Champion Award and to RFDS Flight Nurse, Karen Barlow, who was also recognised with a NSW Premier’s Award.

Dollar for Dusty
Twelve-year-old Dusty Langby is currently walking 540 kilometres from Warren to Parliament House in Canberra to raise \$1 million for the children’s charity Little Wings so they can fly more paediatricians to the bush.
Dusty’s journey kicked off from his hometown Warren on Sunday with a 55km walk to Trangie and he’ll spend the next couple of weeks trekking across NSW to make it to Canberra for a meeting with the Prime Minister at 9am on September 15. I know he’s a little nervous about this meeting, but I reckon he’s got nothing to worry about.

You can follow Dusty’s journey on Facebook and Instagram (@DollarforDusty) and donate by visiting: givenow.com.au/dollar-for-dusty

Support for Nepal
On 26 August 2026, devastating flash floods struck Nepal’s Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhad-ing districts. My thoughts and best wishes are with those affected in Nepal, and also with the large Nepalese diaspora who call the Dubbo electorate home.
Australian Red Cross may be able to assist through their Restoring Family Links program on 1800 875 199.
Australian Government’s 24-hour Consular Emergency Centre can be contacted on 1300 555 135 (within Australia) or +61 2 6261 3305 (from overseas).
All donations made to the Australian Red Cross Global Emergency Fund will go to supporting the Nepal flash floods response.
To donate, visit: redcross.org.au/global-emergency/
Join DNCA’s candlelight vigil in Elston Park, Dubbo on Sunday 6 September from 5pm to 7pm.

Until next time, Dugald

The career of a Wellington Apothecary

The evolution of Pharmacy over the past 60 years

An address to Wellington Probus Club in August by Roger Keirle – for many, the pharmacist in Nanima Crescent.

Roger was born in Bindawalla Hospital (now demolished which was at the front of present Wellington Hopistal), on October 28, 1942.

We quote:
“My father was Harold Olver Keirle born in Eustace Street, Manly, about 300 metres from the Ferry terminal.
His father was Arthur Thomas Keirle who was the mayor of Manly for 10 years over three separate terms.
Dad was the youngest of four brothers and it was his job to chauffeur his father to and from all his mayoral duties.
This was a novelty for a mechanically minded young person like Harold and he went on three trips back to England where he drove everyone around to visit members of Family at his father’s bequest.
So he was a late starter and in 1935 he purchased Griffiths Pharmacy which is the reason I am here today.
My early childhood was fairly normal and I attended Wellinton Primary School and had the privilege of being taught by some great teachers many of whom may be remembered by some of you here today - Irene Fox - 3rd class, a very young John Wallace - 4th class, - Daphne Croft and Jim Cahill.
Jim Cahill ended up marrying Irene Fox. Jim was my teacher in 6th class and the year after that he became the teacher at Nanima Village for 30 years.
He was tough but fair and I was disciplined by the principal Mr Craft on a number of occasions.
He was an expert with the cane.
I was then sent to Scots College in Bellevue Hill from 1954-1958 and I lost track of my local knowledge of Wello to a certain extent.
I spent one year back home in 1959 working as an apprentice with my Dad and then attended Sydney University for three years.
That’s enough about my early childhood and onto the topic of this speech today which is the evolution of Pharmacy over the past 60 years all of which I have spent in Pharmacy.
Today I would like to take you on a journey - not just the last 60 years but through the progression of our Profession from its early origins to the present day.
Lets begin at the very beginning with the word APOTHECARY.
The word Apothecary comes from the Greek word APOTHEKE which was a place where goods were kept.
Over time the meaning shifted to being the keeper of remedies, herbs, spices, powders and potions.
By the medieval period Apothecaries were preparing remedies by hand – grinding herbs and spices, distilling tinctures and dispensing treatments based on tradition, experience and a fair amount of INTUITION.
They belonged to guilds - trained apprentices and served communities much as Pharmacies do today - though with fewer REGULATIONS and considerably more LEECHES.
They all had jars of leeches which were used for many ailments due to their BLOOD SUCKING abilities.
Apothecaries were part scientist, part craftsman and part healer.
Their tools were mortar and pestles, measuring scales and handwritten RECIPES from various and vagarious sources.
Their knowledge came from experience with botanicals, herbs, spices and apprenticeship.
The word Recipe was abbreviated to RX and was also erived from the Latin word.
Indeed, you will find the Guild Gold RX somewhere in most modern-day Pharmacies.
Latin was the language in which most early scripts were written which added another degree of confusion, and even today directions are Latin based.
So I was trained as an APOTHECARY and I went through as an apprentice and as all apprentices are taught - if you made a mess - you had to clean it up and if your boss or anyone else made a mess you had to clean it up as well - no arguments.
My first year in Pharmacy was 1959, a year after I did my leaving certificate and it was the last year of the apprenticeship system.
I went away to Sydney University for three years.
My first-year subjects were Botany, Materia Medica and Pharmacology as all drugs originated from a botanical source of some kind such as the leaves, roots or bark of various naturally occurring plants and still do to this very day. Go figure!!
I found botany to be an unexpected and fascinating subject. I was impressed with the natural and beautiful designs found in nature.
This became more prominent when you were dissecting some plant and cutting them into thin slices and viewing them under a microscope.
Being an apprentice was a very interesting job. My boss was an entertaining Ex-medical detailer for Abbott Laboratories. His top shelf in the Pharmacy was chock full of jars containing 10,000



Peter Sheridan presents Roger Keirle a thank-you memento after Roger addressed Wellington Probus Club in August.

tablets of Phenobarbitone, 30mg each which is a banned or highly controlled drug today. It was a barbiturate and a very popular drug of the time.

I was also an avid Western Suburbs Rugby League supporter working in the Manly area so this precipitated many a controversial conversation.

I might add that Wests had the upper hand in their matches against Manly during my period there.

I went to the SCG every Saturday to watch the match of the day - that was during the dominance of St George at the time and Reg Gasnier was the main man and my favourite player.

I still had to attend University for lectures and Prack lessons and your nights were taken up for study and trying to decipher the notes you scribbled down during lectures.

No Laptops in those days!

But the world was changing and the BANE of my life became more prominent.

It was called CHEMISTRY.

Inorganic chemistry would have to be one of the most boring subjects I can remember. When you moved on to organic chemistry it became much more interesting.

My favourite subjects at school were Geology and Geography and my chosen profession was to be a Geologist but in those days, kids were meant to be seen but not heard so the rest of my life was chosen for me - NOT BY ME.

SUDDENLY MEDICINES COULD BE ANALYSED, PURIFIED AND STANDARDISED.

Active compounds could be isolated, patented and manufactured by Medical Companies so as they could make money which was all they were interested in doing.

This posed a dilemma for me - for when I started Pharmacy there were very few patented products available compared to today and most dispensing was still extemporaneous.

My dilemma was that this was quite often untrue. Nature still held the upper hand and to isolate one active ingredient was not possible because in nature it could be accompanied by 100 or more synergistic ingredients which made it impossible to duplicate.

It would be a bit like baking a cake and leaving out half of the ingredients.

I have since then been a supporter of natural herbs and spices of all kinds as against the patented products.

I am not saying that applies to all patented products on the market today - but caveat emptor - let the buyer beware!

THIS WAS THE TIME WHEN THE WORD CHEMIST OR PHARMACIST superseded the good old APOTHECARY with the loss of all that inherited knowledge.

This basically is the difference between Western and Eastern medicine where all the old tradition of Apothecaries is still dominant in Eastern medicine.

In this country and most Western nations industrial manufacturing has transformed medicine.

The Apothecaries workshop gave way to the modern DISPENSARY.

By the 1950s and 1960s Pharmacies became more formalised. Regulation was established and has not stopped since, but the Pharmacists role was still dispensary focussed.

All scripts were handwritten and you had to develop a 6th or 7th sense to be able to decipher the Doctor’s handwriting.

I think they competed against one and other to see whose handwriting was the worst.

A lot of prescribing was still compound oriented and it was a real challenge to read a handwritten script with up to eight or 10 herbs, tinctures, powders etc all squeezed together on the one script.

Mixtures were made up with cork stoppers, Tablets and Capsules and had to be counted out, placed in containers and labelled.

It had an element of mystery about it as most dispensaries in those days were out of site to the public.

Most of the tablets were white and had no identifying codes on them, unlike today where every tablet or capsule has to have an identification code on it.

Thus, when Mrs Kerfups comes in and wants her little white tablet she last had dispensed five years ago it became a real challenge.

Still, we managed somehow and a warped sense of humour was necessary.

Believe it or not those were the good old days compared to today.

I mentioned before that most dispensaries were out of sight of the public and ours was no exception. It was a large room with a rectangular bench in the centre.

Now it just happened that Harold Keirle was a very capable sportsman (Tennis, Golf and Bowls - in that order).

He was a perfectionist as well and knew the rules of each sport down to a tee - pardon the pun.

So every week there was a constant stream of men that used to come in and discuss the weekend activities and pick his brains as to the rules of the game.

There was also an open fire which I had to keep going 24/7 during the winter. While all this discussion was taking place guess who had to dispense etc. (the poor old apprentice which was me).

Still, the atmosphere was great and the discussions were friendly. I can still remember most of the characters (a lot were local shopkeepers - life was much more relaxed in those days and there were a lot of laughs and general camaraderie).

Life was not as complicated as today. We had no computers, no I-Phones and no social media to contend with.

Our home phone number was 12 and our work number was 59 which all went thru the local exchange in those days.

If you lived outside the town you had to contend with the Party Line for your phone service. Max Christie of Christies Motors reckoned it would be quicker for him to harness the horse and sulky and ride out to see a farmer than rely on the party line.

We were also brought up with the KISS principle (keep it simple stupid).

Every script dispensed had to be hand copied and placed in a filing system of some sort. We had a system where each script was written on a postcard sized piece of cardboard and filed in alphabetical order. We had a large 50-door drawer which was labelled A to Z (still have it in the garage at home).

That was all before the NHS came in.

In 1984 Medicare was introduced and we suddenly became semi-government employees.

Our serenity and independence was over.

Pharmacy became a regulated, politically controlled profession. Pharmacists as a whole - up to then - had been fairly relaxed (politically speaking) and mainly conservative by nature.

However, we soon learnt we had to become politically organised, after being abused by both sides of Government on a regular basis.

Changes were being continually made without any consultation with Pharmacy whatsoever.

The Pharmacy Guild now has headquarters in Canberra and has become one of the most active lobby groups in Australia. It was a matter of necessity, as a result we have a wonderful relationship with Government and both parties benefit from it.

Government determines - what medicines are subsidized and available on the PBS. How much Pharmacists’ are paid - where Pharmacies could be located and what Services they could provide.

This Government control has been both a constraint and an opportunity.

This has now brought about the RISE OF CLINICAL PHARMACY.

By the 1980s and 1990s Pharmacies had moved decisively into CLINICAL CARE.

Pharmacists became – Educators – Counsellors - Medication management specialists - Collaborators in chronic disease care - Hospital Pharmacists - involved in advanced evidence based protocols - anti-microbial stewardship and pharmacokinetic dosing.

TECHNOLOGY - THE DIGITAL REVOLUTION

The past 20 years have brought about a transformation driven by TECHNOLOGY such as - Electronic prescribing - Automated dispensing - Barcode scanning - Real time monitoring - Digital health records - Robotic dispensing systems.

The Dispensary has become a DIGITAL ENVIRONMENT.

Yet-despite all these changes - ONE THING HAS REMAINED CONSTANT (The relationship between the pharmacist and customer - Pharmacists have always been the most accessible HEALTH professionals in the community (ask your pharmacist - he knows!)

For those of us who have lived through the decades we have seen the Profession evolve - from Apothecary to Chemist - from Chemist to Pharmacist - from craft to science - from dispensing to clinical care - from independence to integration - from paper to digital - from local practice to National health strategy.

Ladies and gentlemen - the Profession has changed from Apothecary to Chemist to Pharmacist.

It has not merely changed - it has matured, expanded and risen to meet every challenge placed before it and our communities are healthier because of it.”



6.00 Rage. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Insiders. **10.00** Offsiders. **10.30** The World This Week. **11.00** Compass. **11.30** Songs Of Praise. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Landline. **1.30** Gardening Australia. **2.15** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **3.05** End Game With Tony Armstrong. **3.55** Creative Types With Virginia Trill. **4.25** Amanda & Alan's Italian Job. **5.00** Take 5 With Zan Rowe. **5.30** Back Roads. **6.00** Antiques Roadshow. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **8.20** The Cage. **9.10** Failing. **10.00** Grantchester. **10.50** Father Brown. **11.35** Rage. **2.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Australia's Deadliest. **2.00** South Aussie With Cost. **2.30** Harry's Practice. **3.00** The Yorkshire Vet. **4.00** My Greek Odyssey. **5.00** The World's Most Scenic Railway Journeys. **6.00** Escape To The Country. **7.00** The Vicar Of Dibley. **8.30** Vera. **10.30** Genius: Picasso. New. **11.30** Late Programs.



3.35pm QI. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.25** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **6.10** Old House, New Home. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Lucy Worsley Investigates. Final. **9.25** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **10.15** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.45** Father Brown. **11.30** Nigella At My Table. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Landline. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family: Born Without A Trace. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Australian Story. **8.30** Four Corners. **9.20** Media Watch. **9.35** Planet America. **10.10** Foreign Correspondent. **10.40** ABC Late News. **10.55** The Business. **11.30** Murdoch Mysteries. **11.55** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Weekender. **2.30** Auction Squad. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Australia's Deadliest. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Doc Martin. **8.30** A Touch Of Frost. **10.10** Mighty Ships. **11.10** Escape To The Country. **12.30** Late Programs.



2.00pm ER. **2.45** Fresh Off The Boat. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **5.40** Old House, New Home. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Penn & Teller: Fool Us. **9.15** Whose Line Is It Anyway? **9.35** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Australian Story. **10.30** Planet America. **11.00** Tampa: The Turning Point. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Grantchester. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family: Born Without A Trace. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Foreign Correspondent. **8.30** Tampa: The Turning Point. **9.20** I Was Actually There. **9.50** Take 5 With Zan Rowe. **10.20** ABC Late News. **10.35** The Business. **10.55** Four Corners. **11.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** Escape To The Country. **2.00** Creek To Coast. **2.30** Mighty Ships. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Australia's Deadliest. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Call The Midwife. **8.45** Inspector Morse. **11.05** Escape To The Country. **12.05** Late Programs.



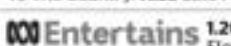
3.35pm Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **5.40** Old House, New Home. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Upper Middle Bogan. **9.00** New Zealand Spy. **9.25** Elementary. **10.05** Late Programs.



6.00 News Breakfast. **9.00** ABC News Mornings. **10.00** Four Corners. **10.45** Foreign Correspondent. **11.15** Back Roads. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** National Press Club Address. **1.35** Media Watch. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.00** Fake Or Fortune? **4.00** Murdoch Mysteries. **4.45** Long Lost Family. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Hard Quiz. **8.30** Spicks And Specks. **9.00** Small Town Scandal. **9.50** Planet America. **10.25** ABC Late News. **10.40** The Business. **10.55** The Cage. **11.45** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **1.00** The Amazing Homemakers. **2.00** Sydney Weekender. **2.30** House Calls To The Rescue. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Australia's Deadliest. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Heartbeat. **8.45** Foyle's War. **10.55** Escape To The Country. **11.55** Late Programs.



1.20pm Elementary. **2.00** ER. **2.40** Fresh Off The Boat. **3.05** QI. **3.35** Would I Lie To You? **4.05** MythBusters. **4.55** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **5.40** Old House, New Home. **6.30** House Of Games. **7.00** Spicks And Specks. **7.30** QI. **8.00** Would I Lie To You? **8.30** Return To Paradise. **9.30** Late Programs.



6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** To Be Advised. **1.35** MOVIE: Battle: Los Angeles. (2011) Aaron Eckhart, Michelle Rodriguez. **4.00** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Sydney Weekender. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** The Voice. **8.45** 7NEWS Spotlight. **9.45** Poisoned. New. **10.55** 24 Hours In Police Custody. **12.00** Curfew. **2.00** Home Shopping. **3.30** Million Dollar Minute. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.30** Al McGlashan's Fish'n With Mates. **3.00** Air Crash Investigations. **4.00** Deep Water Salvage. **5.00** Counting Cars. **6.00** Border Security USA. **7.00** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **8.30** MOVIE: The Lost World: Jurassic Park. (1997) Jeff Goldblum. **11.10** MOVIE: Waterworld. (1995) 1.55 Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **3.00** Play School. **3.25** Tabby McTat. **3.50** Talking Tom Heroes. **4.15** Stan & Gran. **5.20** Stick Man. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** Zog. **7.05** Do Not Watch This Show. **7.30** The Investigators. **7.45** The Lady Grace Mysteries. **8.10** Wild Life: The Big Freeze. **8.55** Animal Park. **10.25** Secrets Of The Zoo. **11.10** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** Beat The Chasers UK. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The Voice. **9.15** The Rookie. **10.15** The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. **11.15** The Agenda Setters. **12.15** Transplant. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Boating. Circuit Boat Drivers C'ship. **4.00** Counting Cars. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** The Agenda Setters: Rugby League. **8.30** Adventure Gold Diggers. **9.30** Gem Hunters Down Under. **10.30** Outback Opal Hunters. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.05** Andy's Aquatic Adventures. **4.30** SuperKitties. **5.15** Octonauts. **5.50** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.05** Spidey And His Amazing Friends. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Young Sheldon. **8.25** Young Sheldon. **8.45** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.30** Hard Quiz Kids. **10.00** Merlin. **10.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** First Dates Australia. **8.40** World's Biggest Cruise Ship. **9.40** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares USA. **10.40** The Agenda Setters. **11.40** Happy's Place. **12.10** The Path. **1.30** Harry's Practice. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Storage Wars. **3.30** Deadliest Roads. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Outback Truckers. **8.30** Outback Wreckers. **9.30** Outback Truckers. **10.30** Heavy Tow Truckers Down Under. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.05** Andy's Aquatic Adventures. **4.30** SuperKitties. **5.15** Octonauts. **5.50** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.05** Spidey And His Amazing Friends. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Young Sheldon. **8.25** Young Sheldon. **8.45** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.30** Harry Potter: Wizards Of Baking. **10.10** Chopped Junior. **10.50** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** Seven's National News At Noon. **1.00** Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** The Chase. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6.30. **7.00** Home And Away. **7.30** The % Club UK. **8.30** The Front Bar. **9.30** Unfiltered. **10.00** The Agenda Setters. **11.00** The Fall And Rise Of Reggie Dinkins. **11.30** Stumble. **12.00** The Fear Index. New. **1.15** Harry's Practice. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** Storage Wars. **3.30** Deadliest Roads. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Highway Patrol. **8.30** The Force: Behind The Line. **9.30** Caught On Dashcam. **10.30** World's Wildest Police Videos. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Kids' Programs. **4.05** Andy's Global Adventures. **4.30** SuperKitties. **5.15** Octonauts. **5.50** PJ Masks Power Heroes. **6.05** Spidey And His Amazing Friends. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago. **8.00** Young Sheldon. **8.25** Young Sheldon. **8.45** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.30** The Piano. **10.30** Merlin. **11.20** Late Programs.



6.00 Hello SA. **6.30** A Current Affair. **7.00** Weekend Today. **10.00** Wide World Of Sports. **11.00** NRL. Sunday Footy Show. **11.45** Rugby League: NRL Women's Premiership. Dragons v Broncos. **1.30** Rugby League: NRL Women's Premiership. Tigers v Titans. **3.30** Rugby League: NRL. Penrith Panthers v Tigers. **6.00** 9News Sunday. **7.00** The Block. **8.40** 60 Minutes. **9.40** 9News Late. **10.10** The First 48. **11.10** Murder In The 21st. **12.00** I Survived A Crime. New. **12.30** Elements Of Disaster. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.30** Home And Away. **2.30** The Voice. **4.00** Ed And Karen's Recipes For Success. **5.00** Animals Aboard With Dr Harry. **6.00** Gold Coast Ocean Rescue. **6.30** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly. **7.30** Law & Order. **8.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **3.30** Offsiders. **4.00** Landline. **5.00** ABC News. **5.30** The Regions. **6.00** ABC Evening News. **6.30** Nine Days In Afghanistan. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** Insiders. **8.30** ABC News Tonight. **9.00** Australian Story: Celebrating 30 Years. **10.10** ABC Late News Weekend. **10.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.30** Find My Country House Australia. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.40** 100% Footy. **10.30** 9News Late. **10.40** Outback Opal Hunters. **11.40** Footy Classified. **12.35** Tipping Point. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** A Current Affair. **5.00** Today Early News. **5.30** Today.



6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Clever. **8.30** Kitty Is Not A Cat. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Australian Doorstep. **10.30** House Rules. **12.00** Revenge. **3.00** The Voice. **4.30** First Dates UK. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Law & Order. **8.30** Law & Order: Criminal Intent. **9.30** Law & Order: SVU. **10.30** Bones. **12.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.10** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.25** Planet America. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.00** Ski Rescue Down Under. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.40** Travel Guides. **9.50** 9News Late. **10.20** Trigger Point. Final. **11.20** Footy Classified. **12.15** Tipping Point. **1.05** GolfBarons. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Let's Eat With George. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** A Current Affair. **5.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Jabba's Movies School Holiday Special. **10.30** House Rules. **12.00** The Unit. **3.00** A Moveable Feast. **3.30** My Greek Odyssey. **4.30** First Dates UK. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** CSI: New York. **8.30** CSI: Crime Scene Investigation. **9.30** CSI: Miami. **10.30** Bones. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **2.00** Parliament Question Time. **3.10** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.10** Four Corners. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** The Block. **1.00** Getaway. **1.30** Destination WA. **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** The Block. **8.45** 70 Years Of Television. New. **10.00** 9News Late. **10.30** Freddy And The Eighth. **11.25** Accused: Guilty Or Innocent? **12.20** Tipping Point. **1.10** Destination WA. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.30** Global Shop. **3.00** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Late Programs.



6.00 It's Academic. **7.30** Get Clever. **8.30** Kitty Is Not A Cat. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Great Australian Doorstep. **10.30** House Rules. **12.00** The Unit. **3.00** A Moveable Feast. **3.30** My Greek Odyssey. **4.30** First Dates UK. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** The Rookie. **10.30** NCIS. **11.30** NCIS: Los Angeles. **12.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **3.10** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** Afternoon Briefing. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Australian Story. **11.00** ABC Late News. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **7.30** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **8.00** Farm To Fork. **8.30** Food Trail: South Africa. **9.00** Freshly Picked With Simon Toohy. **9.30** Good Chef Bad Chef. **10.00** Good Food Everyday With Gary Mehigan. **10.30** Frugal Foodie. **11.00** Deal Or No Deal. **11.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **12.00** My Market Kitchen. **12.30** Gogglebox Australia. **1.30** The Traitors Australia. **3.00** The Finish Line. **4.00** Lingo. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** 10 News+. **7.00** Gogglebox Australia. **8.00** Watson. **9.00** FBI. **12.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **9.00** Roads Less Travelled. **9.30** The Traitors Australia. **11.00** Escape Fishing With ET. **11.30** Building The Dream. **12.30** What's Up Down Under. **1.30** Buy To Build. **2.00** JAG. **4.00** Pooches At Play. **4.30** Bondi Rescue. **5.00** IFISH. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Fire Country. **11.15** JAG. **12.15** Late Programs.



6.00 Tennis. US Open. Day 7 Late. **3.00** Getaway. **3.30** My Favorite Martian. **4.00** Agatha Christie's Marple. **6.00** Rugby League: NRL Women's Premiership. Canberra Raiders v Eels. **8.00** To Be Advised. **9.00** Paramedics. **10.00** Emergency. **11.00** Cold Case. **12.00** Poirot. **1.00** Tennis. US Open.



6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Farm To Fork. **10.30** Entertainment Tonight. **11.00** Gogglebox Australia. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.30** Millionaire Hot Seat. **1.00** 10 News: Lunchtime. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** The Finish Line. **3.30** Lingo. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** Deal Or No Deal. **7.00** Millionaire Hot Seat. **7.30** Deal Or No Deal: Celebrity Jackpot. **8.40** Have You Been Paying Attention? **9.40** 10's Late News. **10.40** Two And A Half Men. **11.35** Late Programs.



6.00 Home Shopping. **8.00** Days Of Our Lives. **8.45** The Young And The Restless. **9.30** The Living Room. **10.30** Building The Dream. **11.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** JAG. **3.30** Bull. **4.30** JAG. **6.30** Bull. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Bull. **11.15** JAG. **1.15** Home Shopping.



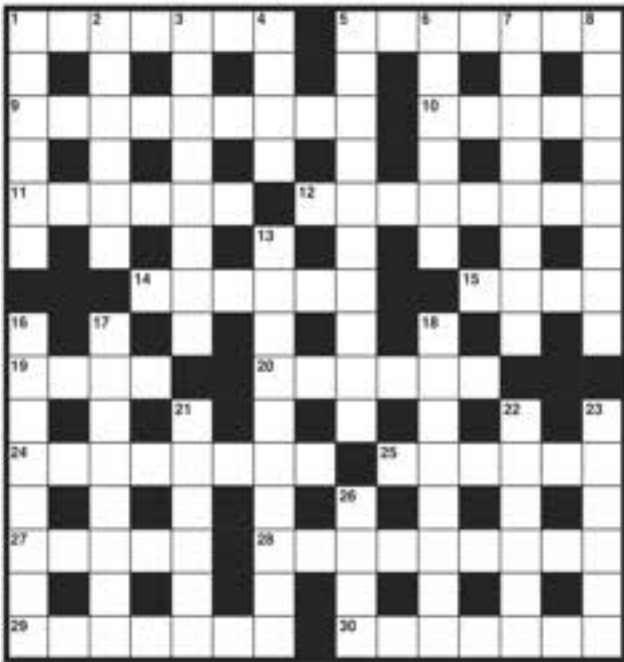
6.00 Tennis. US Open. Day 8 Late. **3.00** Antiques Roadshow. **3.30** Antiques Downunder. **4.00** Find My Country House NZ. **4.30** Poirot. **5.30** The Travelling Auctioneers. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.30** Agatha Raisin. **10.30** Rizzoli & Isles. **11.30** Poirot. **12.30** Antiques Roadshow. **1.00** Tennis. US Open.



6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Lingo. **9.00** The Finish Line. **10.00** Farm To Fork. **10.30** Entertainment Tonight. **11.00** Deal Or No Deal: Celebrity Jackpot. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet With Justine Schofield. **12.30** Millionaire Hot

CROSSWORD

No. 194



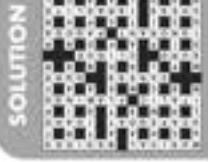
- 27 Tactical board game (5)
28 From Israel (arch.) (9)
29 Core (7)
30 Power source (7)

DOWN

- 1 Adherent of Islam (6)
2 Sacred beetle (6)
3 Elemental (8)
4 Country in Southeast Asia (4)
5 Large warship (10)
6 Brand; disgrace (6)
7 Water course (8)
8 A break in a journey (8)
13 Related to money and trade (10)
16 Middling (8)
17 Royal family member (8)
18 Hungary's capital (8)
21 Jail (6)
22 Beginner (6)
23 Seldom (6)
26 Scuttling sea animal (4)

ACROSS

- 1 Melodious (7)
5 Except; otherwise (7)
9 Taker of blame (9)
10 US state (5)
11 Slanted font (6)
12 Pink bird (8)
14 Stroke lightly (6)
15 Blackguard (4)
19 European currency unit (4)
20 Exclusive group (6)
24 Unlearned (8)
25 Many-tiered Buddhist temple (6)



9-LETTER

No. 194

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

Today's Aim:

- 6 words: Good
9 words: Very good
13 words: Excellent



Effective, effect, effect, effect, effect, effect, effect, effect, effect

WORDFIT

No. 104

3 LETTERS

- ACE
ADO
ARC
BEE
BOO
CAP
CPA
DOT
EEL
EGO
EWE
GIN
GOP
ICE
IRE
IRK
LEE
MEN
MEW
RAN
SKI
TEN
TWO
WAR

- PASS
SACS
SEWS
SING
SULK

5 LETTERS

- ABACK
ACTOR
AGREE
AORTA
AROMA
ARROW
ATLAS
BOOST
CEDES
CELLO
COOEE
EERIE
ENTRY
FIRST
FREER
GAUGE
GRAPE
HORDE
ITEMS
KEENS
KNEES
LAPSE
LARVA
LEAPT
PIPES
POLIO
PRAWN
PRICE
PRIDE

4 LETTERS

- ACHE
ALSO
BASS
BOSS
EMIT
GLUT
LESS
OUST
PART

- PROWS
RADII
RAVEN
RIVET
ROCKY
SCARS
SEEDY
SLOPE
SPIED
SPREE
SPRIG
STEEP
STEPS
TEATS

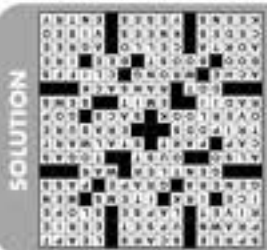
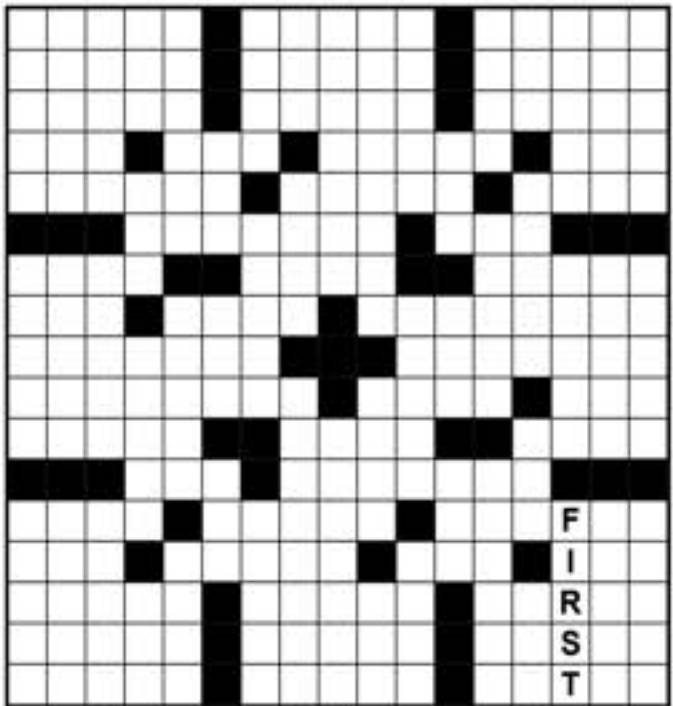
- TEENS
TOGAS
TORSO
UPSET
VISED
WRONG
YESES

- 7 LETTERS
ASPIRES
ERASURE
GENTLER
MANTLES
RANSACK
TRIPODS

- 8 LETTERS
KEROSENE
OVERLOOK
RESTARTS
STALWART

6 LETTERS

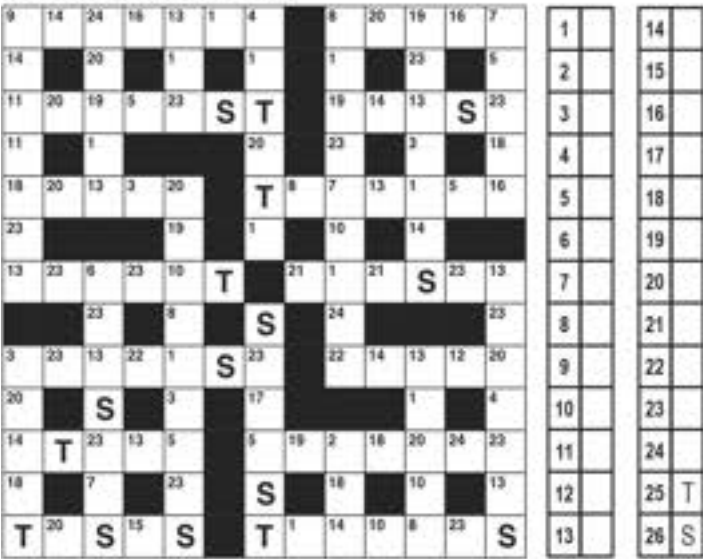
- CLEAVE
CLIFFS
ENTIRE
GENERA



CODEWORD

No. 144

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

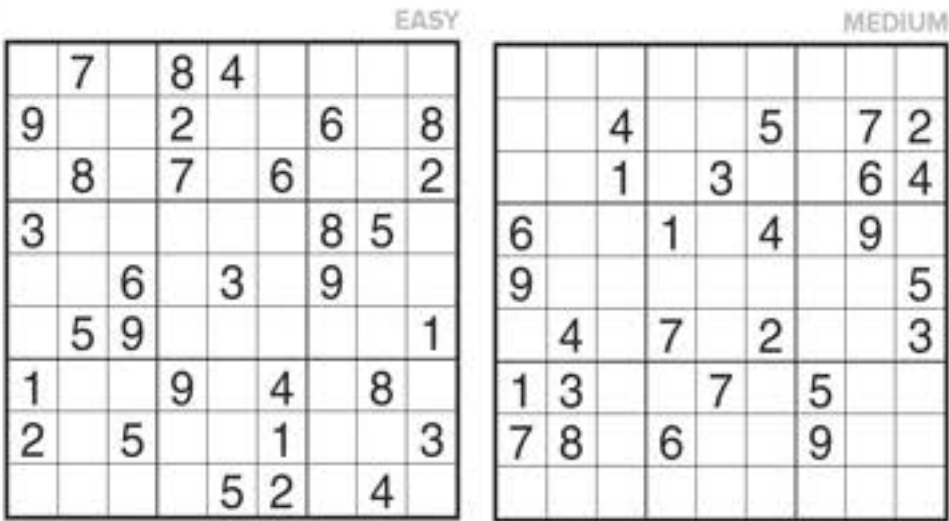


SOLUTIONS: 1=Q, 2=F, 3=V, 4=P, 5=L, 6=Y, 7=8, 8=H, 9=G, 10=C, 11=Z, 12=Q, 13=R, 14=M, 15=U, 16=K, 17=N, 18=L, 19=J, 20=A, 21=T, 22=W, 23=B, 24=E, 25=M

SUDOKU

No. 194

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



QUICK QUIZ

- What is the highest point in South Australia?
- What is the art or science of being a teacher?
- Who was the Marquess of Pembroke?
- What is the currency of Azerbaijan?
- In which country is Hamelin, as referred to in *The Pied Piper of Hamelin*?
- The Fresnel lens was originally developed for use in what?
- Which fictional character has been portrayed by Mickey Rooney, Eddie Hodges, Ron Howard, Elijah Wood (pictured) and Brad Pitt?
- Known as 'The Fat Years', when in the 19th century was Broome's pearl industry booming?
- Who wrote the techno-thriller novel *The Andromeda Strain*?
- In which year was the National Museum of Australia opened?



WORD SEARCH

No. 104

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ANORAK
BELT
BLAZER
BLOUSE
BODICE
BOLERO JACKET
BOOTS
CAP
CLOGS
CRAVAT
CUMMERBUND
FEDORA
GAITERS
GLOVES
HAT
JEANS
ONESE
PEACOAT
PEIGNOR
POLO SHIRT
PONCHO
SANDALS
SARONG
SCARF
SHORTS
SKIRT
SOCKS
SUIT
TIE
TURBAN
TURTLENECK
VEST
WINDBREAKER

SECRET MESSAGE: You're never fully dressed without a jacket

ANSWERS: 1. Mount Woodroffe 2. Pedagogy 3. Anne Boleyn 4. The maras 5. Germany 6. Lighthouses 7. Huckleberry Finn 8. 1889-1891 9. Michael Crichton 10. 2001

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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the
Man on the Land

For More Information
call



Mb: 0428 635 994

Light rain today (Thursday), Saturday and Tuesday a few mm each time.

Crop disease outlook for the 2026+ growing season across NSW will be strongly influenced by climatic conditions, agronomic responses and disease expression observed during 2025 and/or 2024.

Rust variants have broken out in Victoria and southern NSW particularly stripe rust. We must be vigilant and watch out for pustules on the stem and leaves, Stripe rust latent period is highly influenced by and is quickest between 15-20 degrees c. At these optimal temperatures, the latent period is approx 10 to 14 days, but can lengthen during cooler or warmer conditions, as cycling is dormant or slows above 22c and below 8c degrees. Some of the rusts that affect wheat yields are leaf rust, stripe rust, stem rust septoria or yellow rust.

Prevention is better than curative. The protection of the top three leaves on a plant are responsible for up to 90% of the grain fill, with the top leaf (Flag Leaf) responsible for most of that around 75% so it's extremely important to keep these leaves free of rust.

Spring wheat generally produces up to 9 leaves per main shoot, while winter wheat can produce up to 15.

An Interesting quirk of wheat is that it has more stomata on the upper surface of the leaf than on the underside - the reverse of most plants

MARKETS AT A GLANCE

WOOL.. Smallest offering for six years spurred buyers into action. EMI closed 1853c/kg clean, up 41c. 23,651 bales offered, down 14,051. Sydney Merino f1c rebounded across all MPG's. Biggest gains (30 to 83c) on day1, with further 5 to 13c day 2. Merino skirtings lifted 50 to 80c, crossbreds up with strong demand, locks up both days. NRI closed 1918c/kg clean, up 41c. Sydney's pass in rate 1.2% with 294 bales withdrawn. Merino cardings indicator1184c/kg clean. **CATTLE..** CTLX 25th. 1290 head -490. Plenty of cattle in forward condition. Weaner steers lifted 12c to 595c, heifers jumped 20c to 525c/kg. Medium and heavy feeder steers firm, 516c to 560c, lighter steers around 300kg dearer to 576c/kg, heifers firm to \$2 softer, 480c to 530c/kg. Trade cattle lifted 10c, 480c to 513c/kg. Grown steers and bullocks limited supply, lifted 15c, to 480c, heavy grown heifers 8c stronger 455c to 469c/kg. Cows 3 to 5c better on average, heavies 399c to 426c, leaner 2 score cows 369c to 378c/kg. Heavy b-muscled bulls 359c to 435c/kg, up 20c to 30c. **SHEEP..** CTLX 26th. 1575 head, down 1745 after considerable rain area. Heavy trade new season lambs \$260 to \$286, ave 1140c to 1165c/kg cwt. New season restockers \$190 to \$200. Heavy old lambs firm, \$283 to \$310, heavies \$316 to \$335.

MUTTON.. Numbers stayed steady, good heavy ewes \$12 to \$25 dearer. Heavy first-cross ewes \$225 to \$325.

PRODUCE.. Most grains rose well due to inability of Black Sea ports unable to export from port war damage.

STOCK CLEARANCE CONTINUES

Fungicides, herbicides, cereal rust sprays, poly pipe, electric fencing, dips, drenches, small packs, large Avery platform scales, metal shelving, antiques.



Dubbo (02) 6885 0549



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT
Week ending August 28, 2026
AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week 500c/26	This Week 400c/26	Last Sale 500c/26	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
ST	7514	7550	7471	+81	5752	+806
SB	2887	2881	2850	+37	2672	+795
SR	2260	2288	2222	+81	2542	+728
SR5	2212	2193	2123	+90	-	-
20	2052n	2132	2025n	+67	2482	+469
21	-	2026	-	-	-	-
28	895n	895	798n	+42	552	+882
MC	1184n	1082n	1188n	+24	761n	+423

Change of fortune for growers

IN A somewhat complete about face, the market rebounded strongly last week, recouping much of the losses that were seen in the prior week's auctions. The small offering of 23,651 bales was viewed as one of the likely catalyst's, being shown right from the opening lot in all three selling centres, with buyers all well aware of the low levels of inventory across the early-stage processing supply chain. Tuesday had the greatest gains across all indicators and types nationally and was well rounded out on Wednesday with smaller increases in the two remaining centres of Sydney and Melbourne. For the second week running, the EMI in US terms outperformed the results in Australin dollar terms, and being the main currency used in wool trading, should be seen as a confidence boost for the whole industry. The difference in sentiment last week compared to prior is quite remarkable. Talk of historical price movement at this time of year seemed like we were heading for a difficult period over the

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



Plasto & Company

Livestock and Property

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 1299 head. Few weaners and good numbers of lighter feeders, medium and heavy weights limited. Grown steers and heifers in short supply, plainer run of cows with fewer heavies. Market sold to stronger trends. Weaner steers up to 25c stronger to 624c, heifers jumped 40c to 50c, 445c to 534c/kg. Light yearling steers to restocker to 630c/kg. Feeder steers 30c stronger, secondary cattle some of the bigger gains 520c to 581c/kg, heifers 12c to 15c better 496c to 540c/kg. Trade cattle around 20c dearer, 491c to 555c/kg for B muscled Limo heifers. Grown steers and bullocks 475c to 492c, heavy heifers 440c to 488c/kg and lifted 10c/kg. Cows 15c to 20c stronger, high yielding heavies 405c to 425c/kg, leaner 2 score cows 364c to 382c/kg. Best bull to 427c/kg. **DUBBO SHEEP..** 22,000 lambs. Reasonable numbers of trade lambs, good runs of heavy weights. Good numbers of well finished Merino lambs and exotics. Full field of buyers. Trade new season lambs \$6 dearer \$220 to \$300, ave 1190c/kg cwt. Trade old lambs \$8 to \$14 dearer, 20kg to 24kg \$234 to \$300, ave 1155c to 1225c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs \$8 dearer, 24kg to 30kg \$270 to \$349, ave 1145c to 1210c/kg cwt. Over 30kg to \$390. Heavy new season to \$323. Merino lambs \$6 to \$15 dearer, trade \$183 to \$306, heavy Merino to \$329. Restocker lambs held firm, crossbreds and exotics \$120 to \$271. Feeders paid to \$273. Hoggets to \$327/head. **MUTTON..** 3260 head. Most grades were \$10/head dearer. Merino ewes

\$110 to \$320, crossbred ewes \$208 to \$380. Merino wethers \$158 to \$266, Dorper wethers to \$343. Restockers paid \$128 and \$149 for Merino ewes and \$203 for Merino wethers. **WOOL..** Confidence in wool prices returned at a rapid rate last week. Not all past losses were regained however some individual micron indicators did regain everything and even continued to push to higher levels. Small offering of 23,600 bales. Prices were immediately dearer upon Tuesday's opening with NRI climbing 38 cents. Wednesday more settled prices still trending dearer with indicator gaining a further 3 cents. 25 to 90 cent jumps were recorded in individual micron price guides. With the Aussie dollar almost a full cent dearer to US compared to the last sale, the week's result was a 3.6% rise in the EMI when looked at in US dollars compared to a 2.2% rise in local currency. 23,185 bales sold nationally with the strong market resulting in an almost negligible passed in rate of just 2%. Major buyers Techwool, Endeavour Wool and PJ Morris. With three of this week's top four buyers of Merino fleece not appearing in the top four in prior week. Prices falling like they did the week before week probably encouraged some processors off the sidelines allowing buyers to write new business resulting in this increases. Whilst weekly auction offerings currently remain low, we are still sitting at historically high wool prices in general. The longest sustained uptrend lasted for three years. Now two years into this one, it's a wait and see proposition now.

Around the tracks
with Col Hodges

Racing at Gulargambone

MELISSA HARRISON and her apprentice jockey Jess Del Frari were part of a memorable weekend for sports individuals and teams from Forbes when winning the Inland Petroleum-Bill Lambell Memorial Gulargambone Cup last Saturday with Glowing Rapids.

The rugby league teams from Forbes, the Firsts, Reserves, Juniors and League Tag, all won their sem- finals to qualify for the Central West grand finals, while the Jack Smith, Forbes trained champion greyhound Magpie Hector ran a huge race when coming from a long way back to finish second to the West Australian star Miss Envy in the \$150,000 National Distance Final over 715 metres in Melbourne.

Racing in good form throughout the current campaign for the Forbes based trainer Melissa Harrison, Glowing Rapids was well ridden by Jess Del Frari in the 1200 metres Gulargambone Cup.

After having a good run behind the leader Mean Girls (Olivia Dalton, \$21), Glowing Rapids (\$5.50) drew clear to win by a length, with Rivaldo (Juliet Partridge, \$8) a long neck away third.

Racing in front of a big crowd on the very well prepared grass track at Gulargambone, the Brett Robb, Dubbo trained Vastly won the opening event, the 1800m AMPS Agri Benchmark 50 Handicap with Diego Montes de Oca, formerly from Argentina, in the saddle.

Diego Montes de Oca had been riding with success in New Zealand and after his recent move to Dubbo from Sydney he won on the \$26 outsider Dusty Vermeer at Narromine for trainer Troy McCarney.

Leading all the way, Vastly (\$17) won by three lengths from Aoife (Juliet Partridge, \$15) and the \$3 favourite Questionable ridden by Clayton Gallagher

Completing a Gulargambone winning double, Diego Montes de Oca then brought the Connie Greig, Dubbo trained Avoid Me (\$5) with a strong run down the outside from well back to beat East Harlem (Emma Ly, \$4 fav) and Our Celebrity (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$16) in the 1450m Halcroft & Bennett Benchmark 45 Handicap.

Narromine trainer Kylie Kennedy has her team racing well and Calmundi (Juliet Partridge, \$5) from midfield gained an inside run to win the 1200m Gilgandra Toyota Class 1 Handicap from Roman Miss (Clayton Gallagher, \$6) and Well-spring (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$4 fav).

The other winners were Hippeastrum (Jacob Stiff, \$17) trained at Tamworth by Kevin Dixon and the Liam Ruddy, Scone trained Stormy Malice (Clayton Gallagher, \$2.30 fav).

Mendooran Cup is on Saturday and Dubbo TAB on Monday followed by Collarenebri and Geurie Picnics both on Saturday, September 12, Bathurst Sunday, September 13 and Wellington, Tuesday September 15.

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WELLINGTON PUBLIC SCHOOL

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Book Week Parade



Wellington Public School celebrated our annual Book Week Parade, with this year's theme, "A Symphony of Stories."



Students and staff brought their favourite characters to life, showing off an amazing array of colourful and creative costumes. It was a wonderful celebration of books, reading and storytelling, and a fantastic day enjoyed by all!





St Mary's Catholic School

37 Percy St Wellington NSW 2820
Ph: (02) 68451822
www.stmaryswellington.catholic.edu.au



A Book-tastic Book Week at St Mary's

St Mary's Catholic School came alive with stories, costumes and plenty of laughter as students celebrated Book Week 2026 with this year's theme, Symphony of Stories.

Throughout the week, K-4 students enjoyed interactive visits to the Macquarie Regional Library in Wellington, Kindergarten to Year 10 students took part in a Buddy Reading session and the whole school came together for a spectacular Book Week Parade, with students proudly showcasing an incredible variety of creative and imaginative costumes inspired by their favourite books and characters. A highlight of the celebrations was a hilarious performance by the Year 10 students, who brought the much-loved book *Dirty Bertie* by David Roberts to life on stage.

St Mary's would like to give a huge thank you to students, staff and families for helping make Book Week 2026 such a memorable celebration of books, reading and the joy of stories. It has certainly been a symphony of stories at St Mary's!



Junior Redbacks

- Carmen Gain photos

Made it to semi-finals

Wellington's Junior Redbacks Under 12s and Under 16s played hard and left nothing in the tank when they played against Mudgee only to be defeated in the semi-finals.

However, an incredible season for the Redbacks Juniors with next season looking even better.



Golfing news

Ladies Pennents team gracious in defeat

THIS GLORIOUS weather is perfect for golfing and the numbers of players are rising accordingly.

Club Ladies ventured to Bathurst to play their Pennants Semi-Final match against Dubbo last week and while putting in a great showing, just fell short, going down by three matches to two. Winners on the day were Denise Haesler and Pauline Potts, Cheryl Royal went down on the 20th hole, Wendy Slack-Smith went down on the 19th, Marie Cornish just lost. Congratulations and thank you to all the Ladies on representing our Club.

Joe's Mowing Services Winter Cup was finalised on Saturday with John Donnelly claiming the win with his best two rounds totally 140.

Coming in a close second was Mr Runner-Up Tim Parker with a total of 141.

Last Saturday was also an Individual Stroke.

A grade winner was John Donnelly who had a par round to finish with a 67nett. Runner-up was Daniel McCullum on a countback with 71nett.

B grade winner was Peter Neuenhaus who was a comfortable winner with a 73nett. Runner up with 75nett was Wendy Slack-Smith..

Prize winners were Bryan Kiss 71; Aaron Clarke, Kurt Cusack, Nathan Stewart 72; Tim Parker 73; Brad Hyland 74; Rod Pedron, John Gersbach, Cody Conn, Patrick Slack-Smith 75 on a c/b.

Nearest the Pin on the 3rd Gary Cusack, 8th David East,

14th Ashley Bullock, 16th Rod Miller.

NTP in two shots on 17th was Noel Stanford. Longest drive in A grade went to John Donnelly and in B grade Cody Conn.

The Brett Eather Encouragement award was hotly contested again but after all said and done Trent Forrest claimed the prize with a 91nett.

Wednesday was an Individual Stableford and Round 4 of the Cornish-Hollow Trophy.

Winner on a countback was Wendy Slack-Smith who finished with 36pts while Marg Hollow was runner-up.

Prize winners were Marie Cornish 34pts and Kathy Martin 32pts. NTPs, Wendy Slack-Smith and Cheryl Royal.

Winners of the Cornish-Hollow Round 4 were Marg Hollow and Kathy Martin with 68pts.

Thursday was another Individual Stableford attracting good field of golfers.

Winner was Ashley Bullock who compiled a good score of 38pts, while Peter Neuenhaus was runner-up with 37pts.

Prize winners were Paul Hannelly, Daniel McCullum 34pts; Ron Cowan, welcome back Ronny, and James Armstrong 33pts.

Draw for the Quarter Finals of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy see's Brent Eather-Wayne Lang v Rod Pedron-Tim Parker, Rod Irwin-David O'Brien v George Hollow-Gary Cusack, Stephen Whiteman-Joe Ryan lost to John



Ladies Pennants Team: Chery Royal, Wendy Slack-Smith, Marie Cornish, Pauline Potts and Denise Haesler.

Gersbach-Peter Holden, Elton Keeffe-Matt Ringland v Marie Cornish-Teena Campbell.

Quarter Finals are on September 5, Semi-Finals October 3, Final October 17.

The CORING of the GREENS is set down for Monday and Tuesday September 7 and 8, and volunteers would be appreciated.

This Saturday's events are the September Monthly Medal kindly sponsored by Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club plus the Quarter Finals of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy plus the George Hollow Putting Competition.

19th Hole

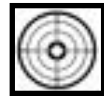
Junior Warriors Gala Day

- Jo Ivey and Jess Chown photos ... from Back Page.





In Their Sights



Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Results from Saturday, August 29.

Hunting Class: S. King 98.12; P. Spedding 95.7; R. Galea 89.3, B. Spedding 85.1; P. Kelly 70.2; G. Elward 65.2; D. Gollan 54.	G. Elward 106.5; J. Pirie 93.1; P. Kelly 78.
600 Yards: L. Hough 116.8; S. King 108.3;	Next Shoot Saturday, September 5 at 500 yards.
	The Rifleman

Your sport can record results in the “Sport” section.

Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

Warriors Seniors

Ladies Fist Grade 1 - South Dubbo Wanderers 0. Mens Second Grade 3 - South Dubbo Wanderers 2 - Jo Ivey photos



Warriors Soccer

Wellington teams make their mark at Dubbo Gala Day

WELLINGTON WAS well represented at the Dubbo Soccer Gala Day last Saturday, with five local teams making the trip for a full day of football.

The Gala Day brought together teams from across the region, giving Wellington players the opportunity to take on new opposition, gain valuable game experience and enjoy a day of football outside their regular competition.

All five Wellington teams competed strongly throughout the day, with players showing plenty of enthusiasm, teamwork and sportsmanship on the field.

The strong Wellington presence did not go unnoticed, with a number of comments made throughout the day about how great it was to see so many teams from Wellington taking part.

For the players, the day was more than just about the results.

It was an opportunity to represent their town, spend time with teammates and enjoy the game in a relaxed and friendly atmosphere.

The Gala Day was also a reflection of the continued growth of football in Wellington, with increasing numbers of local players getting involved in the sport.

Coaches, managers, volunteers and families all played an important role in making the day possible, with many giving up their Saturday to travel to Dubbo and support the teams.

The five Wellington teams returned home having represented the town proudly, with the Gala Day providing another positive experience for the local football community.

Jess Chown **More Photos Page 18.**



It's all a part of teamwork mixed with good fun among Wellington junior footballers.

Jessica Chown photo.

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Soldiers Memorial Club

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